

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250271212

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

August 28, 2025

Inventor(s)

FERGUSON; Scott A.

METALLURGICAL FURNACE HOT PLATE WITH COOLING FEATURES

Abstract

A sidewall or roof for a metallurgical furnace is disclosed herein. The sidewall has a cover plate and a hot plate coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate forming an inner volume of the sidewall. The hot plate is configured to contact molten material. A spray cool system is disposed in the interior volume of the sidewall and configured to spray coolant on the hot plate. The hot plate has an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. The hot plate has an outer surface exposed to the inner volume of the sidewall. A plurality of cooling features extend from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship. The cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.

Inventors: FERGUSON; Scott A. (Murfreesboro, TN)

Applicant: Systems Spray-Cooled, Inc. (Smyrna, TN)

Family ID: 1000007700688

Appl. No.: 18/584808

Filed: February 22, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: F27B3/24 (20060101); F27D1/12 (20060101); F27D9/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC F27B3/24 (20130101); F27D1/12 (20130101); F27D2009/0016 (20130101)

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

Field of the Disclosure

[0001] Embodiments of the present disclosure relates generally to a hot plate having cooling features for a metallurgical furnace, and more particularly to a furnace sidewall or roof having a hot plate with cooling features.

Description of the Related Art

[0002] Metallurgical furnaces (e.g., an electric arc furnace or a ladle metallurgical furnace) are used in the processing of molten metal materials. The electric arc furnace heats charged metal in the furnace by means of an electric arc from a graphite electrode. The electric current from the electrode passes through the charged metal material forming a molten bath of the metal materials. The furnaces house the molten materials during the processing of the molten materials forming molten steel and slag (a stony waste material).

[0003] A metallurgical furnace as above described is typically made of steel, aluminum, aluminum base alloys, copper, copper base alloys and metals having similar thermal characteristics. The surface of the sidewall and roof exposed to the molten material in the furnace become very hot during processing of the molten materials. To dissipate heat from the furnace sidewalls and roof exposed to the molten materials, the metallurgical furnace may have cooling systems. One type of cooling system is a spray cooling system. The spray cool system sprays water on the hot surface in the interior portion of the sidewall and/or the roof of the furnace. The sprayed water is then collecting in a drain and pumped from the sidewall and/or. However, pumping the water into the spray cooling system, then pumping the water out from the drain, as well as the usage and treatment of the water comes is expense.

[0004] Therefore, there is a need for an improved cooling system for a metallurgical furnaces.

SUMMARY

[0005] A sidewall and/or roof of a metallurgical furnace, and a metallurgical furnace having the same are described therein which have cooling features that promote efficient use of cooling fluid. The efficient use of cooling fluid enabled through the use of cooling features formed on the sidewall and/or roof of the metallurgical furnace reduces operating costs while improving cooling performance, which ultimately improves the performance of the furnace.

[0006] In one example, a sidewall for a metallurgical furnace is provided. The sidewall has a cover plate and a hot plate. The hot plate is coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate, thus forming an inner volume of the sidewall. The hot plate has an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. The hot plate has an outer surface exposed to the inner volume of the sidewall. The inner surface of hot plate is configured to face molten material when present in the furnace. A spray cool system is disposed in the inner volume of the sidewall and configured to spray coolant on the outer surface of the hot plate. A plurality of cooling features extend from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship. The cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.

[0007] In another example, a metallurgical furnace roof is provided. The roof has a cover plate and a hot plate. The hot plate is coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate, thus forming an inner volume of the roof. The hot plate has an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. The hot plate has an outer surface exposed to the inner volume of the roof. The inner surface of hot plate is configured to face molten material when present in the furnace. A spray cool system is disposed in the inner volume of the roof and configured to spray coolant on the outer surface of the hot plate. A plurality of cooling features extend from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship. The cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.

[0008] In yet another example, a metallurgical furnace is provided. The metallurgical furnace has a hearth, a sidewall sitting on the hearth and a roof disposed on the sidewall. The hearth, sidewall and

roof define an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. The interior volume configured for processing molten material. The at least one of the sidewall and roof has a cover plate and a hot plate coupled together in a spaced apart relation. An inner volume of the sidewall and/or roof is defined between the cover and hot plates. The hot plate is configured to face molten material when disposed within the furnace. A spray cool system is disposed in the interior volume and configured to spray coolant on the hot plate. The hot plate has an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. The hot plate has an outer surface exposed to the inner volume. A plurality of cooling features extend from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship. The cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.

[0009] In yet another embodiment, a method for cooling a sidewall and/or roof of a metallurgical furnace is provided. The metallurgical furnace has a hearth, a sidewall sitting on the hearth and a roof disposed on the sidewall. The hearth, sidewall and roof define an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. The interior volume configured for processing molten material. The sidewall and/or roof has a cover plate and a hot plate coupled together in a spaced apart relation forming an inner volume. The hot plate is configured to face the inner volume. A spray cooled system is disposed in the interior volume and configured to spray coolant on an outer surface of the hot plate. An outer surface of the hot plate is configured to face an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace. A plurality of cooling features extend from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship wherein the cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0010] So that the way the above recited features of the present disclosure can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the disclosure, briefly summarized above, may be had by reference to embodiments, some of which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrate only typical embodiments of this disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the disclosure may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 1 illustrates a side elevation view of a metallurgical furnace.

[0012] FIG. 2A illustrates a partial sectional view the sidewall of the metallurgical furnace of FIG. 1.

[0013] FIG. 2B illustrates a partial sectional view of the roof of the metallurgical furnace of FIG. 1.

[0014] FIGS. 3A-3F are schematic elevation views of various patterns of cooling features which may be utilized on the sidewall illustrated in FIG. 2A or roof illustrated in FIG. 2B.

[0015] FIGS. 4A-4B are schematic plan views of topological patterns for the cooling features which may be utilized on the sidewall illustrated in FIG. 2A or roof illustrated in FIG. 2B.

[0016] FIGS. 5A and 5B illustrate possible shape variations for the cooling features.

[0017] To facilitate understanding, identical reference numerals have been used, where possible, to designate identical elements that are common to the figures. It is contemplated that elements disclosed in one embodiment may be beneficially utilized with other embodiments without specific recitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0018] The present invention is directed to a furnace sidewall and/or roof having cooling features disposed on an outer surface of a hot face to enhance spray cooling of the sidewall and/or roof. The sidewall and roof of the metallurgical furnace includes a spray-cooled hot plate having an inner surface that faces an interior volume of the furnace. Cooling features are disposed on the outer

surface of the hot plate which is exposed to coolant sprayed thereon by the spray cool system. The cooling features enhance the ability to remove heat and thereby cool the hot plate. The cooling features protect the hot plate from overheating, thereby extending the service life of the hot plate. Moreover, the cooling features desirably promote the adhesion of slag on inner surface of the hot plate, which also extends the service life of the hot plate.

[0019] FIG. 1 illustrates a side elevation view of a metallurgical furnace **100** having a roof **105** removably disposed on a furnace body **110**. The furnace body **110** includes a sidewall **125** disposed on a hearth **115**. The hearth **115** is lined with refractory brick **120**. One or both of the roof **105** and sidewall **125** may be spray-cooled, as further described below. The sidewall **125** has a top **130** and a bottom **139**. The roof **105** is moveably disposed on the top **130** of the sidewall **125**. The roof **105** and furnace body **110** enclose an interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100**. The interior volume **135** may be loaded or charged with material **140**, e.g., metal, scrap metal, or other meltable material, which is to be melted within the metallurgical furnace **100**.

[0020] The metallurgical furnace **100**, including the furnace body **110** and the spray-cooled roof **105**, is rotatable along a tilt axis **145**. The metallurgical furnace **100** may be tilted in a first direction about the tilt axis **145** toward the slag door (not shown) multiple times during a single batch melting process, sometimes referred to as a “heat”, to remove slag. Similarly, the metallurgical furnace **100** may be tilted in a second direction about the tilt axis **145** towards a tap spout (not shown) multiple times during a single batch melting process including one final time to remove the molten material **140**.

[0021] Roof lift members **150** may be attached at a first end to the roof **105**. The roof lift members **150** may be chains, cables, ridged supports, or other suitable mechanisms for supporting the roof **105**. The roof lift members **150** may be attached at a second end to one or more mast arms **155**. The mast arms **155** extend horizontally and spread outward from a mast support **160**. The mast support **160** may be supported by a mast post **165**. A coupling **170** may attach the mast post **165** to the mast support **160**. The mast support **160** may rotate about the coupling **170** and the mast post **165**. Alternately, the mast post **165** may rotate with the mast support **160** for moving the roof lift members **150**. In yet other examples, roof lift members **150** may be aurally supported to move the roof **105**. In one embodiment, the roof **105** is configured to swing or lift away from the sidewall **125**. The roof **105** is lifted away from the sidewall **125** to expose the interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100** through the top **130** of the sidewall **125** for loading material therein.

[0022] At least the sidewall **125** of the furnace body **110** may be ring, oval or circular-shaped when viewed from a top plan view, of which a portion is shown in FIG. 2. Likewise, the roof **105** has a shape complimentary to that of the sidewall **125** so that the interior volume **135** may be enclosed.

[0023] A central opening **175** may be formed through the roof **105**. Electrodes **180** extend through the central opening **175** from a position above the roof **105** into the interior volume **135**. During operation of the metallurgical furnace **100**, the electrodes **180** are lowered through the central opening **175** into the interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100** to provide electric arc-generated heat to melt the material **140**.

[0024] The roof **105** may be coupled to a coolant supply **132** and one or more coolant drains **152**. The coolant supply **132** may provide coolant to the roof **105**. The coolant drains **152** may remove the spent coolant from the roof **105**. The roof **105** may further include an exhaust port to permit removal of fumes generated within the interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100** during operation. The sidewall **125** and the roof **105** will be discussed further below with respect to FIGS. 2A and 2B respectively.

[0025] FIG. 2A illustrates a partial sectional view of the sidewall **125** of the metallurgical furnace **100** of FIG. 1. The sidewall **125** comprises a hot plate **200** and a cover plate **205**, both of which are shown in cross-section in FIG. 2A. The hot plate **200** is coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate **205**. The hot plate **200** and the cover plate **205** have a ring, oval or circular-shape, which forms the sidewall **125**. An inner volume **202** of the sidewall **125** is defined between the hot

plate **200** and the cover plate **205**.

[0026] The cover plate **205** is fabricated from steel or other suitable material. The cover plate **205** has an exterior surface **215** and an interior surface **216**. The exterior surface **215** faces the ambient environment where the metallurgical furnace **100** is utilized. The interior surface **216** is exposed to the inner volume **202** of the sidewall **125** and faces the cover plate **205**.

[0027] The hot plate **200** is fabricated from steel or other suitable material. The hot plate **200** has an inner surface **210** and an outer surface **230**. The hot plate has an upper surface **201** and a lower surface **203**. In operation, the upper surface **201** is oriented above the lower surface **203**. The inner surface **210** faces the interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100** (shown in FIG. 1). The outer surface **230** is exposed to the inner volume **202** of the sidewall **125** and faces the cover plate **205**.

[0028] A plurality of slag retainers **240** may be coupled to the inner surface **210** of the hot plate **200**. The slag retainers **240** project from the inner surface **210** of the hot plate **200** into the interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100**. The slag retainers **240** is configured to trap slag produced by a batch melting process performed in the metallurgical furnace **100**.

[0029] A spray cool system **280** is disposed in the inner volume **202** of the sidewall **125** between the cover plate **205** and the hot plate **200**. The spray cool system **280** has a header **282** and a plurality of nozzles **284**. The plurality of nozzles **284** are coupled to the header **282**. Liquid, such as water, is provided through the header **282** to the nozzles **284** such that the liquid may be sprayed through the nozzles **284** onto the outer surface **230** of the hot plate **200**. The liquid is utilized to cool the hot plate **200** during operation of the metallurgical furnace **100** to prevent damage to the sidewall **125**.

[0030] Cooling features **250** are provided on the outer surface **230** of the hot plate **200**. The cooling features **250** are thermally coupled to the hot plate **200**. The cooling features **250** extend from the outer surface **230** of the hot plate **200** in a spaced apart relationship. The cooling features **250** are arranged in a manner such that spray from the nozzles **284** comes in contact with at least some of the cooling features **250**. The cooling features **250** are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate **200** by the spray cool system **280**. The cooling features **250** are arranged to allow the spent coolant to flow down the outer surface **230** substantially without creating coolant separation zones on the outer surface **230** below the cooling features **250**. Stated differently, the cooling features **250** are shaped and oriented to substantially prevent an area of the outer surface **230** downstream, relative to the flow of coolant running across the outer surface **230**, of the cooling features **250** from in not receiving coolant flowing across the outer surface **230** as the coolant passes the cooling features **250**. The cooling features **250** may be applied in areas of high heat on the hot plate **200**. For example the cooling features **250** may be applied in areas of the hot plate **200** more likely to have high heat load such as near the hearth **115**, near a burner port, slag retainers **240**, or where flames from a burner contact the hot plate **200**, while areas of the hot plate **200**, such as near the roof **125**, may have less or even be void of the cooling features **250**. In this way areas of high heat can be more efficiently cooled, prolonging the life of the sidewall **125**.

[0031] Additionally or in the alternative, cooling features **250** may also be provided to improve cooling of the roof **105** of FIG. 1. FIG. 2B illustrates a cross section for a roof **105** of FIG. 1. The roof **105** has a sidewall **220** adjoining the cover plate **205**. The sidewall **220** is connected to a bottom surface **234** by the hot plate **200**. The hot plate **200** in the roof **105** is substantially similar, though not the identical, to the hot plate **200** of the sidewall **125** and for purposes of this disclosure, will be discussed similarly.

[0032] The roof **105** has a central opening **175** configured to allow electrodes to extend therethrough and heat the material within the interior volume **135**. The central opening **175** has a sidewall **220** extending from the cover plate **205** to the bottom surface **234**. The sidewall **220**, cover plate **205**, hot plate **200**, and a bottom surface **234** surrounds an enclosed space **291** of the roof **105**. The hot plate **200** and bottom surface **234** of the roof **105** is exposed to elevated temperatures in the

interior volume **135** of the metallurgical furnace **100**.

[0033] The roof **105** has a spray-cooling system inside the enclosed space **291** substantially similar to spray cooling system **280** disposed in the sidewall **125**. The spray cooled system **280** is configured to cool the roof **105**. That is, the spray-cooled system **280** has a header **282** and a plurality of nozzles **284**. The header **282** provides a coolant **286** to the nozzles **284** for spraying the coolant on the interior surfaces of the roof **105**, such as the sidewall **220**, hot plate **200** and bottom surface **234**. One or more of the nozzles **284** may be inside the roof **105** or aligned to spray the coolant **286** on the hot plate **200**. The outer surface **230** of the hot plate **200** is exposed to the enclosed space **291**.

[0034] Cooling features **250** are provided on the outer surface **230** of the hot plate **200** in the roof **105**. The cooling features **250** are thermally coupled to the hot plate **200**. The cooling features **250** are arranged in a manner such that spray from the nozzles **284** is directed at them. The cooling features **250** are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate **200** by the spray cool system **280**. As such, the cooling features **250** are arranged to allow drainage of the spent coolant out one or more of coolant drains **252**.

[0035] The cooling features **250** disclosed above in the roof **105** and sidewall **125** may be arranged in a variety of patterns, shapes and configurations to promote not only heat removal from the hot plate **200** but also removal of the spent coolant from the roof **105** and sidewall **125**. Testing was performed to arrive at a shape, number of features and topological orientation of the cooling features **250**. Unexpectedly, different example results showed not all examples performed nearly as effectively as other examples. The following discussion of the enhanced cooling features **250** will disclose the examples tested to arrive at the preferred shape, number of features and topological orientation of the cooling features **250**.

[0036] FIGS. **3A-3F** will be discussed in conjunction with FIGS. **5A** and **5B**. FIGS. **3A-3F** are schematic elevation views of various patterns of cooling features which may be utilized on the sidewall illustrated in FIG. **2A** or roof illustrated in FIG. **2B**. FIGS. **5A** and **5B** illustrate possible cross-sectional shape **500** variations for the cooling features. The cooling features **250** are expressed in 2D shapes when viewed from above or in cross-sectional plane parallel to the hot plate **200**. It is understood that the hot plate **200** is curved. Thus, when stating the cross-section plane is parallel to the hot plate **200**, it is intended to refer to a tangent to a point where the cooling feature **250** contacts the hot plate **200**. The cross-sectional slice has a cross-sectional shape **500**. In one example, the cross-sectional shape **500** is that of a rectangular shape **510**. The rectangular shape **510** of the cooling features **250** may have adjacent sides which are not equal in length. Alternately, the rectangular shape **510** may have equal length sides. That is, the rectangular shape **510** may be that of a square. In another example, the cross-sectional shape **500** is that of an ellipsoid shape **520**. The ellipsoid shape **520** may have major and minor axis. The major axis may be substantially axially aligned with gravity, or vertically. In other words, the major axis is substantially aligned from the top **201** of the hot plate **200** to the bottom **203** of the hot plate **200**. For example, parallel with a centerline of the roof **105** or sidewall **125**. Alternately, the ellipsoid shape **520** may have a major axis equal to the minor axis. That is, the ellipsoid shape **520** may be a circle.

[0037] Various test for cooling efficiency was devised to determine the optimum cross-sectional shape **500**. In one example, the ellipsoid shape **520** having a major axis and minor axis between about **2.00** inches and about **3.00** inches exhibited excellent heat removal and cooling properties. For example, cooling features **250** having the ellipsoid shape **520** being circular in shape with a **2.63** inch diameter exhibited surprising results over the cross-sectional shape **500** being rectangular and square in shape. Furthermore, it was found that the ellipsoid shape **520** promoted shedding of the coolant in a manner that prevented a first cooling feature **250** from shading a second cooling feature **250** vertically below the first cooling feature.

[0038] The cooling features **250** may be welded or otherwise fastened to the hot plate **200** in an arrangement such that sprayed coolant moves down the cooling features **250** to a drain. The cooling

features **250** may be substantially perpendicular to the hot plate **200**. Alternately, the cooling features **250** may be angled on the hot plate **200** to promote a line of sight between the cooling features **250** and coolant sprayed from the spray cool system **280** to ensure coolant from the spray cool system **280** hits the cooling features **250**. The cooling features **250** may extend a distance **336** from the hot plate **200**. The distance **336** each cooling feature **250** extends from the hot plate **200** may or may not be the same. For example, the distance **336** the cooling features **250** extend from the hot plate **200** may be greater the further the cooling features **250** are away from the nozzles **284** of the spray cool system **280**. Alternately, the distance **336** the cooling features **250** extend from the hot plate **200** may be greater the further the cooling features **250** are away from the top to the hot plate **200**. The cooling features **250** may extend a distance between about 1.50 inches to about 10 inches, such as about 2 inches to about 5 inches. In one example, the cooling features **250** extend a distance of about 3 inches or less.

[0039] Turning to FIG. **3A-3B**, the cooling feature **250** may be a rectangular fin shape **310**. The rectangular fin shape **310** is oriented in a vertical manner to prevent water from pooling on the cooling feature **250** or creating regions on the hot plate **200** that are not wetted by coolant below the cooling feature **250**. Spacing between horizontally adjacent cooling features **250** having the rectangular fin shape **310** may be optimize to promote spray along the entire surface of the rectangular fin shape **310**.

[0040] Turning to FIG. **3C-3D**, the cooling feature **250** are illustrated as a series of studs **320**. The studs **320** may have a width **324**. The width **324** of the studs **320**, when square, corresponds to a length of an edge side. The width **324** of the studs **320**, when round, corresponds to a diameter. In the example depicted in FIGS. **3C-3D**, the studs **320** have a circular cross-section. Although each cooling feature **250** is shown with the width **324** being equal, it is contemplated that the width **324** for each cooling feature **250** may be adjusted based heat load. A spacing **322** is provided between the studs **320**. The spacing **322** between adjacent vertically arranged studs **320** may be even.

Alternately, the spacing **322** between adjacent vertically arranged studs **320** may be different. The spacing **322** between vertically adjacent studs **320** may be optimize to promote spray along the entire surface of each cooling feature **250**. It has been found that the studs **320** shed water and promote better draining of the spent coolant than the fin shape **310** while importantly promoting the flow of coolant around the stud **320** to quickly rejoin, thus substantially preventing dry spots on the hot plate **200** below the studs **320**.

[0041] Turning to FIG. **3E-3F**, the cooling feature **250** are illustrated as a series of pins **330**. The pins **330** may be square or round. In one example, the pins **330** have a cross-section having the ellipsoid shape **520** being circular, i.e., the major axis equals the minor axis. The pins **330** have a width **334** measured at a cross-sectional slice of the cooling features **250**. In one example, the width corresponds to a diameter of the pins **330**. The pins **330** are spaced a distance **332** from adjacent vertical pins. The distance **332** may be the same or greater than the width **334** of the pins **330**. In one example, the distance **332** between the pins **330** is greater than four times the width **334** of the pins **330**. The width **334** of the pins **330** may be optimized for removing heat from the hot plate **200**. It should be appreciated that the width **334** of each pin **330** may or may not be exactly the same depending on heat load. In one example, the width **334** of the pins **330** are between about 1.75 inches and about 3.50 inches.

[0042] FIGS. **4A-4B** are schematic plan views of topological patterns for the cooling features **250** which may be utilized on the sidewall illustrated in FIG. **2A** or roof illustrated in FIG. **2B**. The topological patterns of the cooling features **250** are shown with a vertical orientation to the page in FIGS. **4A-4B**. It should be appreciated that the topological patterns of the cooling features **250** may be vertically aligned in practice, such as with gravity. The topological patterns of the cooling features **250** are provided to shed spent cooling fluid from a first cooling feature **451** without impinging on the effectiveness of a second cooling feature **452** lower on the hot plate **200**. For example, spent warm coolant shedding from the first cooling feature **451** may fall on the second

cooling feature **452** and diminish the cooling capacity of sprayed colder coolant directed to the second cooling feature **452**. Additionally, the first cooling feature **451** may shade the second cooling feature **452** and partially block coolant directed at the second cooling feature **452**.

[0043] FIG. **4A** illustrates a first topological pattern **410** for the cooling features **250**. The first topological pattern **410** may have rows **480** and columns **470** of cooling features **250**. The cooling features **250** may have any cross-sectional shape described above with respect to FIGS. **5A** and **5B**. The cooling features **250** may have any number of rows **480**, such as a first row **481**, a second row **482**, a third row **483**, etc. The cooling features **250** may have any number of columns **470**, such as a first column **471**, a second column **472**, a third column **473**, etc.

[0044] The rows **480** may have row spacing **491** corresponding to a first distance. The columns **470** may have column spacing **492** corresponding to a second distance. It should be appreciated that the column spacing **492** may or may not equal the row spacing **491**. It should also be appreciated that the column spacing **492** between the first column **471** and second column **472** may or may not be equal to the column spacing **492** between the second column **472** and the third column **473**. Additionally, it should be appreciated that the row spacing **491** between the first row **481** and second row **482** may or may not be equal to the row spacing **491** between the second row **482** and the third row **483**.

[0045] In another example, the first topological pattern **410** has equal row spacing **491** between each row **480** of cooling features **250**. In another example, each row **480** may be spaced according to heat load on the hot plate **200**, such that the row spacing in hotter areas are closer together than cooler areas of the hot plate **200**. Additionally, the rows **480** of cooling features **250** may be positioned only in portions of the hot plate **200** experiencing high heat load, such as opposite slag retainers **240**.

[0046] In one example, the first topological pattern **410** has equal column spacing **492** between each column **470** of cooling features **250**. In another example, each column **470** of cooling features **250** may be spaced according to heat load on the hot plate **200**. For example, the column spacing in hotter areas, are closer together than cooler areas of the hot plate **200**.

[0047] The cooling features **250** may be linearly aligned in both the rows **480** and the columns **470**. For example, a first cooling feature **451** may be in a first row **481** and a third column **473**. A second cooling feature **452** may be in a second row **482** and the third column **473**. The first cooling feature **451** is topologically oriented directly over the second cooling feature **452**. This provides an easy arrangement for installing the cooling features **250**.

[0048] FIG. **4B** illustrates a second topological pattern **420** for the cooling features **250**. Similar, to the first topological pattern **410**, the second topological pattern **420** may have rows **480** and columns **470** of cooling features **250**. Alternately, the cooling features **250** may have a staggered pattern. The staggered pattern having been found to prevent pooling of spent coolant. As such a pattern is difficult to discuss, the discussion will proceed with respect to rows **480** and columns **470** to aid in understanding the possibilities in the arrangement of the cooling feature **250**.

[0049] The first column **471** of cooling features **250** may be spaced a first distance **434** from a cooling feature **250** horizontally adjacent in the third column **473**. Similarly, the first row **481** of cooling features **250** may be spaced a second distance **432** from the cooling features **250** vertically adjacent in the third row **483**.

[0050] The second topological pattern **420** has a vertical offset **435** for cooling features **250** in an adjacent columns **470**. Similarly, the second topological pattern **420** has a horizontal offset **431** for cooling features **250** in an adjacent row **480s**. For example, a second row **482'** having a second cooling feature **452'** is both vertical offset **435** and horizontal offset **431** from the third row **483** having a third cooling feature **453'**. Although shown vertically aligned, it should be appreciated that the cooling features **250** in the first row **481** may not align with the third row **483**. In one example, the second topological pattern **420** has random horizontal offsets **431** between adjacent cooling features **250** to maximize the vertical spacing between adjacent cooling features **250**. Similarly, the

second topological pattern **420** may have random vertical offsets **435** between adjacent cooling features **250**. In this manner, adjacent cooling features **250** are spaced apart to provide line of sight unimpeded access to coolant being sprayed from the nozzle **284**.

[0051] It was unexpectedly found that setting the cooling features **250** in a topological geometric pattern of about 7 inches to about 3 inches on center, i.e., the next adjacent cooling feature **250**, as shown by the arrow **499**, enhances spray cooling by providing a substantial density of cooling features **250** sprayed with coolant from the nozzles **284**. In one example, the cooling features **250** are in a pattern 4 inches on center. In another example, the cooling features **250** are in a pattern 6 inches on center. Additionally, staggering the pattern of the cooling features **250**, as opposed to having rows, has been found to prevent water channels from forming wherein the coolant channels downward along a side face of the cooling feature **250** reducing the cooling capabilities of cooling features **250** positioned below by reducing the amount of coolant contacting those cooling features **250**. The cooling features **250** having round shaped studs were additionally found to perform better than rectangular shaped fins. The cooling features **250** having round shaped studs do not blocked water spray or provide shading to additional cooling features **250**. Placement of the cooling features **250** in high heat areas, such as opposite the slag retainers, or near the O.sub.2 burners, help reduce the temperature of these areas. The cooling features **250** were found to remedy slag wash off from the slag retainers **240** due to the high heat load on the hot plate **200** in the areas of the slag retainers **240**. Thus, the cooling features **250** shaped and arranged as described above were found to enhance spray cooling of the hot plate **200** and reduce the amount of coolant used and removed. Thus, the cooling features **250** reducing the operational costs of the spray cooled metallurgical furnace.

[0052] While the foregoing is directed to embodiments of the present disclosure, other and further embodiments may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof, and the scope thereof is determined by the claims that follow.

Claims

1. A sidewall or roof for a metallurgical furnace, the sidewall or roof comprising: a cover plate; a hot plate coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate, the hot plate and the cover plate defining an inner volume there between, the hot plate comprising: an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace; an outer surface exposed to the inner volume and facing the cover plate; and a plurality of cooling features extending from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship into the interior volume; and a spray cool system disposed in the inner volume and configured to spray coolant on the outer surface of the hot plate and into contact with the cooling features.
2. The sidewall or roof of claim 1, wherein the cooling features have a major axis substantially aligned with from a top to a bottom of the hot plate.
3. The sidewall or roof of claim 1, wherein a first cooling feature of the cooling features comprises: a width measured at a cross-section of the first cooling feature; and a length extending from the hot plate into the inner volume.
4. The sidewall or roof of claim 3, wherein the length of the first cooling feature is between about 2 inches to about 10 inches.
5. The sidewall or roof of claim 1, wherein the cooling features are pins, wherein at least one of the pins has a diameter about 1.75 inches and about 3.50 inches.
6. The sidewall or roof of claim 5, wherein the cooling features are arranged in rows and columns and wherein a first cooling feature in the first row is immediately adjacent a second cooling feature in a third row.
7. The sidewall or roof of claim 5, wherein the cooling features are arranged in a staggered pattern on the hot plate.

- 8.** The sidewall or roof of claim 4, wherein the cooling features are studs having a square cross sectional shape.
- 9.** A sidewall for a metallurgical furnace, the sidewall comprising: a cover plate; and a hot plate coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate forming an inner volume of the sidewall, the hot plate configured to contact the molten material, a spray cool system disposed in the inner volume of the sidewall and configured to spray coolant on the hot plate, the hot plate comprising: an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of a metallurgical furnace; an outer surface exposed to the inner volume of the sidewall; and a plurality of cooling features extending from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship wherein the cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.
- 10.** The sidewall of claim 9, wherein the cooling features have a major axis substantially aligned with from a top to a bottom of the hot plate.
- 11.** The sidewall of claim 9, wherein the cooling features comprises: a width measured at a cross-section of the cooling features; and a length, wherein the cooling features extend their length from the hot plate.
- 12.** The sidewall of claim 11, wherein the length of the cooling features is between about 2 inches to about 10 inches.
- 13.** The sidewall of claim 12, wherein the cooling features are pins and the width of the cooling features correspond to a diameter of the pins and wherein the width is between about 1.750 inches and about 3.500 inches.
- 14.** The sidewall of claim 13, wherein the cooling features are arranged in rows and columns and wherein a first cooling feature in the first row is immediately adjacent a second cooling feature in a third row.
- 15.** The sidewall of claim 13, wherein the cooling features are arranged in a staggered pattern on the hot plate.
- 16.** The sidewall of claim 12, wherein the cooling features are studs having a square cross sectional shape.
- 17.** A metallurgical furnace comprising: a hearth, a sidewall sitting on the hearth; and a roof disposed on the sidewall, the hearth, sidewall and roof defining an interior volume of the metallurgical furnace, the interior volume configured for processing molten material, the sidewall and roof comprising: a cover plate; and a hot plate coupled in a spaced apart relation to the cover plate forming an inner volume of the roof, the hot plate configured to face the inner volume, a spray cooled system disposed in the inner volume of the roof and configured to spray coolant on the hot plate, the hot plate comprising: an inner surface configured to face an interior volume of a metallurgical furnace; an outer surface exposed to the inner volume of the sidewall; and a plurality of cooling features extending from the outer surface of the hot plate in a spaced apart relationship wherein the cooling features are configured to enhance the cooling of the hot plate by the spray cool system.
- 18.** The metallurgical furnace of claim 17, wherein the cooling features comprises: a width measured at a cross-section of the cooling features taking in a plane of the hot plate; and a length, wherein the cooling features extend their length from the hot plate and the length of the cooling features is between about 2 inches to about 10 inches.
- 19.** The metallurgical furnace of claim 18, wherein the cooling features are pins and the width of the cooling features correspond to a diameter of the pins and wherein the width is between about 1.750 inches and about 3.500 inches.
- 20.** The metallurgical furnace of claim 18, wherein the cooling features are arranged in a staggered pattern on the hot plate.
-